



AA is a powerful tool...



But impact depends on fit.

Earlier aid, livelihood protection, or both?

AA as earlier aid

Moderate — manageable losses expected

SHOCK SEVERITY

Smaller or instalment-based transfers

TRANSFER DESIGN

Limited, unclear, or high-risk options

AVAILABLE ACTIONS

Welfare gains accelerated

Outcomes converge with reactive assistance

LIKELY OUTCOME

AA as livelihood protection

Severe — extensive asset loss threatened

Large, lump-sum transfers

Clear, low-risk protective actions exist

Livelihood strategies preserved

Outcomes reactive aid cannot replicate

Implications

POLICY

Prioritize scaling AA where acting early delivers distinct value and complements other response or resilience tools

PROGRAMMING

Match AA design to the primary job it is meant to do, and to the shock contexts where it is responding

EVIDENCE

Move from retrospective synthesis to prospective testing of key design choices, including their cost effectiveness
